

**GPU**

The GPU, or the Graphics Processing Unit, more commonly known as the graphics card, isn't something that a regular consumer can perform much maintenance on, so we would advise keeping your screw driver set away for now and simply clean up some dust that may have gathered in and around the fans while also blowing some pressurised air through the heatsink to get some excess dust out.

This will help in the better ventilation of air through the PC and also result in better GPU performance.

In case it has been some time since you bought your GPU, we would also recommend taking it to an experienced professional who can take it apart and change up the thermal paste that is applied on the dye, i.e., the main chip that does the most amount of work, as this would make better contact with the heat spreader reducing the temperatures when the GPU is under load.

**CPU**

Once you have taken out your GPU and performed maintenance on it, the next thing to unplug and take out, is your motherboard along with the CPU attached to it.

Ensure that you unscrew all the screws on it before taking it out. Once out, place it on a non-conductive surface to make sure the mother-

board doesn't receive any stray ESD charges that may damage the chipset.

Unscrew the heatsink on the CPU in a cross pattern so the pressure remains constant on the CPU and as the heatsink comes off, don't forget to take the backplate out as well.

Once you have access to your CPU, wipe the thermal paste off using some rubbing alcohol and dry wipes. Next, apply some fresh thermal paste on the CPU in an X pattern while putting in a dot in the center of the free spaces. This method of application ensures maximum amount of spread which helps in the conduction of heat from the CPU to the heatsink.

**HEATSINK**

Once you have your CPU clean, divert your attention towards the heatsink.

For your heatsink, use pressurised air in between the fins and clean up the fan that is attached to it in a similar way. Once it is clean enough that you can see through the fins, make sure you wipe the contact piece with rubbing alcohol and dry wipes as well before putting the heatsink back on.

**MOTHERBOARD**

Moving on, we now get to the motherboard, if we are being honest, there's not much that one can do in order to perform maintenance on the Motherboard except

for getting rid of dust using pressurised air and changing out the CMOS battery if it has been about 3 years since it was last changed.

You can get a compatible battery for the CMOS at any computer hardware store and should be easy enough to replace.

**AIR FILTERS**

If your case has air filters, make sure you take them out and dust them off well. In the long run, it is not uncommon for people to find large accumulations of dust on the filters which block the flow of air into the case making it a space heater because of insufficient cooling.

Once you have your dust filters out, use some pressurised air to get the dust buildup off of it and then use a soft bristled brush to brush off any other smaller dust buildup on or around the filter.

If you feel that there is still quite some dust left on the filters, you may wash them under running water and only place the filters back into the case once they are fully dry or else you might be putting your PC at risk.

**CASE**

The PC case – this is a tricky one to maintain as there are multiple levels to it. You could either dismantle the case completely and clean out every last bit of it, or you could simply put it through some pressurised air and be done with it.

Either way, some good cable management is something that always goes a long way for the case and its configuration.

The way each case is structured is different so it is a lot more subjective as to how you can place your fans

and in what configuration to get the optimal amount of airflow through your PC and its components.

Though it is something that takes some time to figure out, but finding a good flow path for the way air enters your PC and then exits is a necessity that a lot of people overlook.

An easy way to look at it and plan for airflow in your case is to look at all the possible inlets and outlets in your case for air and placing fans on them in either a push, or a pull configuration to direct the air that comes in or goes out of the case.

Once you have an airflow pattern in mind, go ahead and place the fans at the desired grills and then, start putting things back into the case in the reverse order that you pulled them out.

CONCLUSION

You might be wondering, why we didn't go into power supplies, well the answer to that is simple, opening up a power supply is simply not recommended because of the sheer amount of danger that it poses to your life and so, we don't advise it.

Apart from the power supplies, we also didn't go into maintenance for hard drives and SSDs as those simply require them to keep them well and clean in terms of software and they're usually good to go.

Well folks, that is it for the maintenance for your PCs and we hope you will shower your computers with more and more love now that you know how to! And if you don't, trust us we'll know and the goblins of dust will talk your PC into submitting to the darkness unless you get rid of them! **d**



Worth its weight in gold